telephone table, and his clothes had been ironed and packed inside his suitcase. Much ado about nothing! Lal Chand had spent three hours caught up in a whirlwind of his own making, and to top it all, had missed his dinner as well.

I have always had a special love for Germany and the German people. Over the years, I have been back several times, visiting many cities, including Frankfurt, Cologne, Munich and even Berlin during the Cold War years. When I saw the Berlin Wall, I was deeply saddened to see how one nation had been forcibly split into two by this forbidding artificial boundary. It was yet another instance of how the lives of ordinary citizens are disturbed by politics. The Germans were familiar with my records and achievements and admired me to such an extent that they even had calendars printed with my photograph.

From Germany we flew to London, and then on to the British army base at Aldershot, about 140 miles away, where we had to undergo a military training course. We were put up in the barracks, while our manager, a naval officer called Commander Pereira, stayed at the officers' quarters nearby. We had brought along a cook from India, Harnam Singh, who had once been employed by the Maharaja of Patiala. We had also carried dry provisions like flour, pulses and masalas, and would go to the market every day to buy fresh vegetables, meat or chicken so that Harnam could prepare desi-style khana for us. None of us could have survived on bland English food.

One day, I received a visit from a distraught Englishman who lived on the military base. He had a peculiar problem that he wanted to share with me, which involved the Indian 32-mile walking champion, Zora Singh. The champion had a flourishing six-inch-long handlebar moustache, whose tips almost reached up to his eyes. Apparently, when Zora walked past their house, his appearance so terrified the English officer's three-year-old son that he would shriek in fear. Zora Singh, oblivious of the impact he had, tried to be friendly, but the child was too traumatized to be pacified. Our team was highly amused by the incident and persuaded Zora Singh to either avoid interacting with the child or trim his moustache. He decided to trim it; after all, he could always grow it back again once we returned to India.

Behind the barracks there was a large, beautifully maintained playing field, where we would practice every morning and evening. Our next event, was an important athletic contest in London, in which sportsmen from fifty